

1) Replication report - 25 points

Criterion	Excellent	Competent	Weak	Points
Paper motivation and research design	Clear, accurate summary of the original paper's question, economic mechanism, identification strategy, data, and main findings.	Mostly accurate summary, with some omissions or minor misunderstandings.	Unclear, incomplete, or materially inaccurate description.	6
Understanding of empirical method	Demonstrates strong understanding of the macro time-series method used (e.g., VAR/SVAR, local projections, external instruments, sign restrictions, narrative shocks) and explains why it fits the paper's question.	Shows a working understanding, but the explanation is partly mechanical or incomplete.	Shows limited grasp of the method or misstates core econometric ideas.	7
Replication fidelity	Clearly documents what was successfully replicated, what differs from the original paper, and why, and compares key tables, figures, or IRFs against the published version.	Replication is mostly successful, but documentation of discrepancies is limited.	Replication effort is incomplete, poorly documented, or not clearly linked to the original results.	8
Quality of writing and organization	Concise, well organized, professional, and easy to follow.	Generally clear, with some organizational or exposition problems.	Difficult to follow, poorly organized, or careless.	4

2) Replication package - 20 points

Criterion	Excellent	Competent	Weak	Points
Completeness	Package includes all code, data (or data-construction instructions), outputs, and a usable README.	Mostly complete, but with a few missing pieces or vague instructions.	Major files are missing, or instructions are insufficient.	8
Reproducibility	Another user can run the package and reproduce the core results with minimal friction.	Reproduction is possible but requires nontrivial troubleshooting.	Package does not run reliably or cannot reproduce the central results.	8
Transparency and professionalism	File structure, naming, comments, and README are clear and professional; sources and transformations are documented.	Usable, but somewhat disorganized or under-documented.	Disorganized, opaque, or difficult to audit.	4

3) Extension and empirical analysis - 30 points

Criterion	Excellent	Competent	Weak	Points
Quality of extension question	Asks a clear, nontrivial extension question that is policy-relevant or otherwise clearly hypothesis-driven and that genuinely builds on the original paper.	Extension is relevant but modest, obvious, or somewhat under-motivated.	Extension is vague, disconnected from the original paper, or purely cosmetic.	8
Appropriateness of empirical design	Uses a sensible design given the question and data, and explains why the method is appropriate and which assumptions matter.	Design is workable but not fully justified or not especially sharp.	Design is poorly matched to the question or reflects weak methodological judgment.	8
Execution and evidence	Analysis is carefully implemented; results are clearly presented; robustness or sensitivity checks are thoughtful; limitations are acknowledged.	Execution is adequate but limited in depth, robustness, or interpretation.	Analysis is superficial, fragile, or hard to interpret.	8
Interpretation and contribution	Conclusions are disciplined, economically meaningful, clearly distinguish evidence from speculation, and show what was learned beyond the original paper.	Interpretation is reasonable but somewhat overstated or underdeveloped.	Interpretation is weak, overstated, or disconnected from the evidence.	6

4) Final presentation and slides - 25 points

Criterion	Excellent	Competent	Weak	Points
Organization and time allocation	Presentation is well paced, with roughly half devoted to replication and half to the extension, and fits the time limit cleanly.	Reasonably organized, but timing or balance is uneven.	Poor pacing, major imbalance, or significant overruns.	5
Explanation of methods and results	Slides clearly explain identification, estimation, and interpretation of shocks, IRFs, and results for an academic audience.	Main ideas are communicated, but some explanations are rushed or unclear.	Methods or results are confusing or too superficial.	8
Quality of visuals	Figures, IRFs, tables, and slide design are readable, informative, and well integrated into the argument.	Visuals are usable but occasionally crowded, hard to read, or not well discussed.	Poorly designed or unreadable slides; visuals do little analytical work.	5
Oral delivery and command of material	Presenters speak clearly, answer questions well, and demonstrate command of both the original paper and their extension.	Delivery is adequate, with some uncertainty in Q&A or exposition.	Weak delivery or limited command of the project.	7